

Complaints, Feedback & Escalation

Make it safe to speak up and respond fairly

Suggested training type: Read + mini quiz Suggested pass mark: 80% Review/validity: 12 months recommended review cycle

Learning objectives

- Respond safely and respectfully when a participant raises a concern.
- Understand that complaints can be anonymous and should not trigger retaliation.
- Know when concerns need urgent escalation.
- Use feedback as a source of service improvement.

1. Complaints are a right

Participants must be able to raise concerns about their supports without fear. A worker should never threaten, pressure, shame or disadvantage someone for making a complaint.

2. What to do when someone complains

- Listen without arguing or becoming defensive.
- Thank the person for raising the issue.
- Check whether there is an immediate safety risk.
- Record the concern accurately and explain what will happen next.
- Escalate through Opus Care's complaints or incident pathway as appropriate.
- Keep the person informed within the worker's role and do not make promises you cannot keep.

3. Complaints versus incidents

A complaint can also reveal an incident, abuse concern, privacy breach or immediate safety issue. If so, use the relevant safeguarding/incident process as well - do not treat it as 'just a complaint'.

4. External complaints

People may contact the NDIS Quality and Safeguards Commission about the quality or safety of NDIS-funded supports. Workers must not obstruct or retaliate against a person for exercising that right.

5. Learning from feedback

Good services look for patterns: repeated lateness, poor communication, missed preferences, documentation gaps, rostering issues or safety concerns. The purpose is not only to close the complaint but to improve support.

Knowledge Check

Choose the best answer for each question. Suggested pass mark: 80%. This quiz checks understanding of the module; it does not replace supervised practical competency where that is required.

1. How should a worker respond when a participant complains?
 - A. Argue immediately
 - B. Listen, check safety, record and escalate appropriately
 - C. Tell them complaints are disloyal
 - D. Delete the complaint

2. Can a complaint reveal an incident?
 - A. No
 - B. Yes
 - C. Only if police are involved
 - D. Only if made in writing

3. What is retaliation?
 - A. Improving services after feedback
 - B. Punishing or disadvantaging someone for raising a concern
 - C. Giving a receipt
 - D. Asking for clarification

4. Why should complaints be analysed after resolution?
 - A. To identify learning and service improvement
 - B. To find someone to blame
 - C. To discourage future complaints
 - D. There is no reason

5. Can participants contact the NDIS Commission about provider/worker quality and safety?
 - A. Yes
 - B. No
 - C. Only registered providers can
 - D. Only lawyers can

Manager answer key is included in the accompanying quiz JSON file.

Source and reference notes

This Opus Care resource is an original internal training summary. It is based on current public guidance and does not reproduce third-party courses. Workers should use the linked official resources where specified.

- <https://www.ndiscommission.gov.au/complaints/complaints-about-supports-and-services-you-provide>
- <https://www.ndiscommission.gov.au/complaints/report>
- <https://www.ndiscommission.gov.au/rules-and-standards/ndis-code-conduct/make-it-known-make-it-better>

Important: Internal completion does not create a nationally recognised qualification, professional licence, or practical competency. Opus Care should verify external qualifications and practical skills appropriate to each worker's role and the supports actually delivered.